In case you are looking for a way to ship your own source code, check out the file provisioner (see https://www.packer.io/docs/provisioners/file), which allows you to upload local files when building AMIs with Packer.

15.4 Comparing approaches

In this last section, we will compare the three different options to deploy applications on EC2 that you have learned about while reading through this chapter. We discussed the following three different methods to deploy applications on EC2 instances in this chapter:

- *AWS CodeDeploy*—Uses an agent running on the virtual machines to perform in-place deployments
- *AWS CloudFormation with user data*—Spins up new machines, which will execute a deployment script at the end of the boot process
- *Packer by HashiCorp*—Enables you to bundle the application into an AMI and launch immutable servers

All three options allow zero-downtime deployments, which is a game changer because it allows you to roll out changes without having to ask for a maintenance window in advance. The introduced tools also support deploying changes to a fleet of virtual machines gradually. But the approaches also have differences, as shown in table 15.2.